



ALPHADOG ASSIST SERVICE DOG TRAINING

**Specialized Task Training at Marin's Premier
Dog Boarding, Daycare and Training Facility!**



Welcome to AlphaDog Assist!

“ As someone with a long history of PTSD initially due to military nursing duty, I am medication free and venturing out as Covid subsides thanks to the professional and kind training we (meaning both dog and handler) received at AlphaDog. ”

— JENIFER, OWNER OF FIONA
(PSYCHIATRIC SERVICE DOG)

“ A lot of the training is hands-on for the handler in real life situations. Hobey's behavior around other dogs and people is impeccable. His service skills help me everyday to get along with my activities of daily living and deal with my disabilities safely and effectively. I recently completed a cross country flight (4.5 hrs) with Hobey at my feet. No problemo! He did fantastic. Highly recommend Sierra and AlphaDog Assist. ”

— MATT, OWNER OF HOBEY
(MOBILITY ASSISTANCE SERVICE DOG)

VOTED
BEST OF
MARIN!



Who We Are

Marin's premier dog boarding, daycare and training facility.

Located conveniently just off of CA-101 in Mill Valley, we offer task training for many different types of Service Dogs.

Our training team is comprised of qualified and empathic individuals who are passionate about improving the lives of others and make it their mission to help people lead a healthier, happier life every day thanks to their furry friend.





What Is Service Dog Training?

The Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 defines a Service Dog as one that “actively mitigates a single handler’s disability by performing a necessary task.”

We train the following types of Service Dogs:

Psychiatric Service Dogs

These dogs help with psychiatric disabilities such as anxiety, depression, PTSD, obsessive compulsive disorder (OCD), and more. The tasks they may perform include deep pressure therapy for grounding and calming,

panic attack mitigation to alert the owner when a panic attack is oncoming, interruption of anxious or harmful behaviors such as nail picking, leg bouncing, excessive hand washing and reminding their owners to take medication at the same time each day.

Mobility Assistance Service Dog

These dogs assist handlers who need help with balance or fall recovery due to various medical conditions. They can also perform other physical daily tasks for individuals who have limited mobility.

Cardiac Alert Service Dogs

These dogs are trained to alert their owners to cardiac changes such as high or low blood pressure, or for blood sugar changes for Diabetics.

Migraine Alert Service Dogs

Using saliva samples, the dog is taught to scent for the specific enzymes in the handler’s saliva so they may alert the handler to an oncoming migraine prior to the start of distressing symptoms. This allows the owner to take medication in time to prevent the migraine altogether.



What Is Facility Dog Training

Facility dogs partner with a handler/ facilitator working in a health care, visitation or education setting. These dogs are trained to help the handler's clients.

We train the following type of facility dogs:

Reading Dogs

These dogs go into schools with a counselor or reading specialist to help children who struggle with anxiety around learning to read. Allowing a child to read to a dog takes away the pressure associated

with reading aloud to a person. The dog may also be trained in deep pressure therapy to assist with anxiety and emotional regulation in the school setting.

Psychiatric Facility Dogs

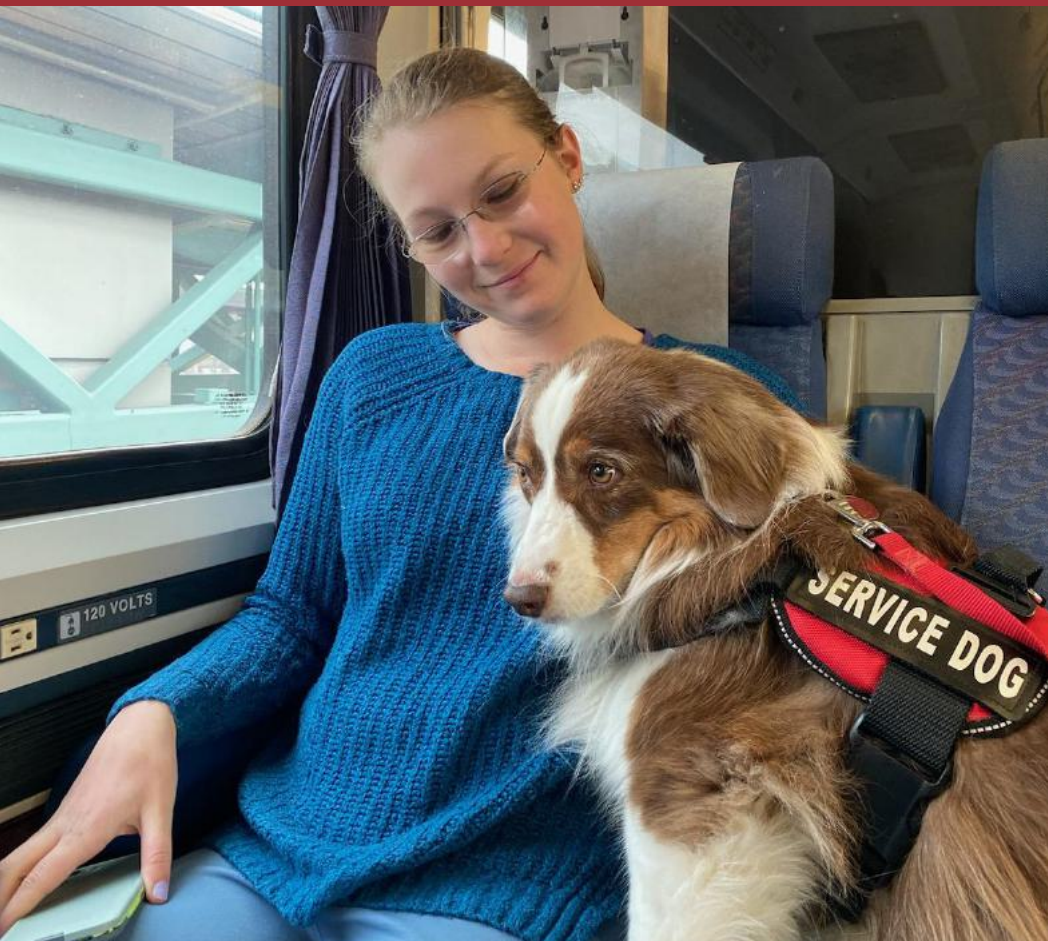
This type of Facility dog partners with professionals like therapists, psychiatrists, psychologists to provide clients with emotional support and tasks like deep pressure therapy during sessions.

Other types of Facility dogs are considered on a case by case basis.

“ After training with AlphaDog, Bowdie now is always comfortable and does not get anxious easily. We now can bring him on walks without a leash, his recall is amazing and he comes right away when called, and we take him everywhere with us. He has been able to help me so much by doing deep pressure therapy as trained service dog. He is so excited whenever he gets to go to AlphaDog to play with the other dogs and the staff could not be nicer. They are always so sweet with him and have such great customer service. If you are looking for a place to train your dog or have them go to daycare you **MUST** go to AlphaDog! They are truly **AMAZING!** ”

— CAROLINE, OWNER OF BOWDIE
(PSYCHIATRIC SERVICE DOG)

Meet Our Trainers



Sierra Berrick manages our program and is our head Service Dog Trainer. She is currently pursuing her PhD in Psychology and she personally understands how a Service Dog can change one's life for the better and how they may aid one on the path to recovery from mental illness. Her service dog, Missy, has been working for Sierra since 2018.

Mike Wombacher is our Senior Training Director, and has been training dogs for over 30 years. During that time he has performed over 40,000 private consultations covering the entire spectrum of dog behavior from the mundane to the bizarre.

An area of special interest to Mike is training Service Dogs for combat veterans with PTSD and first responders of all kinds. Mike's partner spent many years as a war correspondent on the battlefields of Iraq embedded with the US Army and Marines. Over the course of 13 combat tours, she was injured by gunfire, IED explosions and rocket attacks. She also witnessed the death of 30 friends and untold others she never knew. As with so many combat veterans, the worst scars were internal, and these slowly destroyed her life.

It was only when Mike trained a dog for her as an emotional companion that her symptoms began dissolving.



The Path to a Trained Service Dog

Step 1: Contact Us!

Reach out about your Service Dog training needs. An in-person follow-up meeting will be scheduled to discuss details.

Step 2: Visit Our Facility!

We invite you and your dog to try out our facility, free of charge. On this day, our lead trainer will meet with you to finalize your custom training plan.

Step 3: Begin Training!

This process begins with our trainer teaching your dog specialized tasks 1:1, then teaching you how to practice with your dog at home.

Step 4: Public Access!

Once your dog begins to perform their tasks in public, high level obedience will be emphasized in order to prepare the handler and dog team to pass the AKC Canine Good Citizenship Test and Urban Canine Good Citizenship Test (CGC and CGCU).

Step 5: Practice!

The handler and dog team will work with a trainer twice a week to ensure they are feeling confident in a variety of situations and that the dog can perform their tasks around any distractions.

Step 6: Graduation!

You and your dog will take a day trip with the head trainer to demonstrate all you have learned! After this, your dog is considered fully trained.

“ Training a service dog is a long process that every owner needs to be prepared for, but with Sierra's guidance we saw him picking up the scent work required faster than any of us expected! Thanks to her training Basil even saved Christmas this year, alerting me successfully an hour before I started exhibiting migraine symptoms and not backing down until I took my meds. I'm so proud of our little pup and so happy we chose AlphaDog to help us along this journey. ”

— JENN, OWNER OF BASIL
(MIGRAINE ALERT DOG)



FAQs



What are the different types of assistance dogs?

Service Dog

Specially trained to actively mitigate a handler's disability by performing a necessary task.

- Full public access by law
- Covered by Americans with Disabilities Act and Fair Housing Act
- High standard of obedience training

Facility Dog

Partners with a handler/facilitator working in a health care, visitation or education setting

- Does NOT have full public access by law
- Not protected by ADA or Fair Housing Act
- High standard of obedience training

Emotional Support Dog

A pet that provides comfort by being present

- Does NOT have full public access by law however the Fair Housing Act applies
- No standard for obedience training

Therapy Dog

A pet that volunteers with the owner in settings like hospitals and retirement or nursing homes to provide affection and comfort.

- Does NOT have full public access by law
- May only perform visitations as a volunteer with a specific agency
- Basic obedience training required

The Law and Service Dogs

We take the legal rights of our clients very seriously. Part of Service Dog training will include an education for the handler on the laws that apply.

By law, the only two legal questions someone can ask as Service Dog handler are:

1. "Is that a Service Dog?"
2. "What task is the dog trained to perform?"

The handler does NOT have to:

- Provide documentation
- Demonstrate the dog's task
- Say why they need a service dog
- Leave a location due to other's fear of dogs or allergy concerns.

WHAT ABOUT DOGS IN TRAINING?

The Americans with Disabilities Act does not cover dogs in training.

However, the California Disabled Persons Act allows people with disabilities, and individuals who train service animals, to bring a dog into any public place for the purpose of training the dog to provide a disability-related service.



ASSIST

Contact Us!

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